VOL 115 #1 JANUARY - FEBRUARY 2010

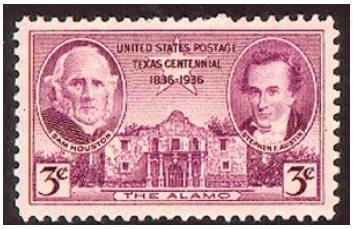
THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



MEETING CALENDAR

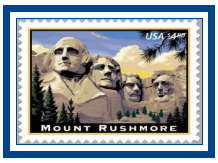
JANUARY			FEBRUARY		
8	Juniors Combined BOG* & General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm 7:30 pm	5	Juniors Combined BOG* & General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm 7:30 pm
9	Saturday Boursette – buy, sell, trade	9:00 am			
15	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	12	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
22	Juniors Program: "First Day Ceremonies" by Nelda Greer	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	19	Juniors Program: "African Americans on Stamps" by Richard Barnes	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
29	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	20	Saturday Boursette – buy, sell, trade	9:00 am
	HAPPY VALENTINE'S ♥ DAY - FEB. 14 ♥		26	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm

03/05-Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell 03/06-Sat.Boursette 03/12-Auction 03/19-Jrs, Program 03/26-Bourse

*BOG = Board of Governors

Martin Luther King Day - Jan 18

Presidents' Day - Feb 15



Editor's corner

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

Welcome to our new Officers and Board of Governors, who were voted in by acclaimation at our Annual Christmas Party. They are: John Clay-President, Nelda Greer-Vice-President, Pat Richmond-Secretary, Skip Swinney-1 year term, Charles Shelby-2 year term, and Jane Fohn is now our Past President. There are no changes in the other offices. Many thanks go to last year's officers, who did a great job for our club.

Lea's Philatelic New Year's Resolutions

1) I'm going to get my new stamp cupboard organized so that I can find things.

2) I need to get the Philatex pages ready before it's the last minute!

3) I will continue to participate at Stamp Club meetings, including the Saturday Boursettes. I hope all our members will join me in this one!

Dora's Membership Message

Check your Philatex for your 2010 membership card. If it is not there, it's because we have not received your dues payment by the time of mailing the newsletter. You can still get the $12 rate by making sure your payment gets to Dora Roberts, Membership Chairman, 12204 Ridge Crown, San Antonio, Tx. 78247, by Dec. 31st. After that it will be $15. If your payment is not received by Jan. 31st, you will be regretfully dropped from the membership roster. Upon later payment of your dues, you will be reinstated with your current membership number.

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	John Clay
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jane K Fohn
One year term:	Skip Swinney
Two year term:	Charles Shelby
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Philatelic Society:	
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books	John Clay
Oklahoma Circuit Books	

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

New President's Message

I hope everyone has had or will have a happy holiday.

I am looking forward to being your president for the 2010 year. It is my hope to continue on with the great tradition that has been laid down before me. SAPA has experienced a rich and long past history.

My goal is to provide us with more opportunities for stamps. That's why we gather together every week. In order to meet this goal, I would like to explore more efficiently the Saturday Boursettes and the Silent Auctions. It would be helpful if you also provide your inputs regarding your wants and needs, Anything that would enrich our enjoyment with our hobby will be helpful.

You can call me on my cell phone 827-7941 or e-mail me at jrclay50@SBCGLOBAL.NET.

While I have your attention—HELP. We need someone to take over the Oklahoma Circuit Books. Jane is no long able to provide the great support she has provided us in the past. Thanks for a job well done, Jane.

BYE for now.....*John*

Program Notes

January 22, 2010 "First Day Ceremonies" by Nelda Greer

"Since 1950, when a new stamp is issued, there is usually a First Day Ceremony...." That's as far as I am going to go to tease you about Nelda's program. Her synopsis that she gave me sounds very informative. When you add her sparkling personality to the mix, I'm sure it will also be very entertaining. We are looking forward to you program, Nelda.

February 19, 2010 "African Americans on Stamps" by Richard Barnes

Richard tells me that his program will concentrate on the various areas that are involved in the scope of the attention that black Americans have received in philately. Some of these areas are Martin Luther King, Black Heritage Stamps as well as other "Black America Themes".

He tells me that he has some Cinderella treats to share with us also.

With Richard's penchant for having a robust collection, I feel certain that he will provide an informative as well as entertaining evening. I'm looking forward to it, Richard.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

WELCOME WAGON

We are pleased to announce that we have a new member. We extend to him a welcoming hand, and wish him many years of happy collecting.

Dave Conrad #2804 -- Worldwide

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

JAN 9-10 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the TraveLodge (new hotel name), 7611 Katy Frwy., Houston, Texas. Hours: Saturday 10am to 5pm, Sunday 10am to 4pm.

FEB 6-7 TSDA SAN ANTONIO STAMP FAIR Bourse at Norris Conferrence Center, 4522 Fredericksburg Rd (at Crossroads Mall near NW I-410 and I-10, next to SuperTarget, lower level), San Antonio, Texas. Hours: Saturday 10am to 5pm, Sunday 10am to 4pm.

FEB 12-13 TSDA DALLAS STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd.(Next to Richardson City Hall), Richardson, Texas. Hours: Friday 1pm to 8pm. Saturday 9am to 4pm.

LONE STAR CHAPTER of the Èire Philatelic Association International meets 2nd Saturday between 2:00pm and 4pm every month in member's homes. Various aspects of Irish philately, and philately in general are discussed. All are welcome. For information call (210)658-9235.

SAPA LIBRARY IS BACK IN BUSINESS!!

Located in a secure metal cabinet in a cozy room in Building #6, where the Quilters meet and where the Saturday Boursette is held, the reference collection is available for members every Wednesday morning (get better times from Pat Richmond) and on Boursette Saturdays.

As in the past, the check-out procedure is simple. A list of books in our library was distributed to members earlier this year, but if you would like a copy, send me a request.

Richard Rose, Librarian

Closed Albums

We are sad to report that Anne K. Yale, SAPA #1938, died May 26, 2009 at her home in Austin, TX. She joined SAPA March 21, 1969. Her family and friends will miss her.

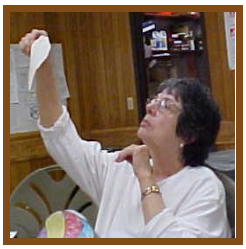
FRED SAYS:

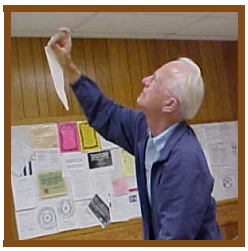
You probably have heard of Project Gutenberg which is working on preserving all literature on-line. Well, there is a Philatelic Digital Library Project which is part of Project Gutenberg. The URL is http://www.tpdlp.net/.

Anyone interested in what philatelic material is already on-line, and anyone interested in helping the project, should go to the URL.

Program Notes November 20, 2009
"Watermarking and Tagging" by Richard Spies

Richard started his presentation by sharing with us envelopes that were made with special government watermarks. These watermarks were placed in the paper as well as some of the early stamps for the purpose of proving their authenticity. As you can see from the pictures below, he had everyone "sky-lighting" the envelopes.





Those of us who are not as familiar with the *Scott's Specialized Catalogue* were pleased to know that this catalogue shows the types and styles of watermarks in the United States Postal Stationery. One of the other items used by the postal system is newspaper wrappers. They have watermarks, also. One of the wrappers that Richard showed us was catalogued W-485.

The paper comes in big rolls and the symbols are pressed into them as they are made. One special type of paper sample that Richard showed us was called "Classic Laid".

Richard showed us a device for filtering red/blue background from a stamp to spot the postmark written in black ink. One way of tagging stamps is florescence. This method is used in the canceling of stamps in a stamp machine. If the cover goes through without the florescence visible, the machine reroutes the cover, turns it and sends it past the canceling head again.

Richard once again wowed us with his vast knowledge of postal items. We all were informed as well as entertained by Richard's personality. Thank you, Richard. We are looking forward to your next program.

Program Notes October 23, 2009 "The Alamo" by Jane Fohn

On October 23, 2009, Jane promised us a collection of Alamo Memorabilia and that she did!!! She had a very nice handout with a cover on the cover which was an item from the Cinderella Precancel Stamp Society 73rd Convention held in San Antonio in 1994.

Her program began with some information about the Alamo from the *Texas Almanac* and a picture of Gov. Allan Shivers with a First Day Cover of the Alamo stamp canceled on June 14, 1956 and autographed by Gov. Shivers. The cachet was a very nice SAPA Witte Museum cachet. She continued with a collection of post cards depicting the Alamo, the long barracks and the Alamo Plaza. One of the cards was canceled in 1906.

The program continued to show how the Alamo edifice has influenced architecture and advertising in San Antonio. The Alamo has been featured in many places in and outside of Texas. The Alamo Plaza Hotel Courts were all over Texas and other states.

One of two very impressive covers featuring the 1936 Texas Centennial stamp was this cover from the Hindenburg First Flight from New York City to Frankfurt in 1936.

The second of my two favorite covers was the following First Day Cover featuring the 1936 Texas Centennial Stamp. It has a Henry hand-drawn, hand-painted Add-On Cachet (signed by Henry) which features the Alamo.

Jane's father, Gillis King originally organized the 1st First Day Ceremony for the Alamo Stamp. On June 14, 2006, Jane got the opportunity to follow in her Father's footsteps. She organized the 50th anniversary of the Issue of the Alamo Stamp.

Jane went on to show some other of her "favorite" things. One of which was a cover with cachet and cancellation designed by Lyle Boardman a SAPA and Austin-Texas Stamp Club Member. The cachet had an owl sitting on the Alamo reminding us to "Remember the OWLamo"

The program concluded with two covers that could only be seen to be truly appreciated. They celebrated the 50th Anniversary Issue of the Alamo Stamp. Both show the unique "touch" of Lyle Boardman. Jane spent the morning with her exhibit. She then sold 50th anniversary covers.

Jane's program was delightful as well as informative. She has promised me (and I intend to hold her to this promise!!!) that she will give me a color copy of the program. It will be made into a Power Point presentation and put on CD for our library. If you missed the program, maybe you can catch it "on the flip side" when it gets in the library.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

New Officers: Jack Virta, Charles Shelby, Chip Swinney, Pat Richmond, John Clay, Nelda Greer

Carolyn Virta, Judy Grant, Jeff White, Orila Brandt, Kurt Harding, Richard Spies

Richard Spies & Bro. Ed Loch

Jack & Carolyn Virta

THE FEAST

Rose & Bill McNally

Amy McNally & Jerry Denton

Lily Littrell & Pat Richmond

Dora Roberts & Lea Senghaas

John & Reiko Clay

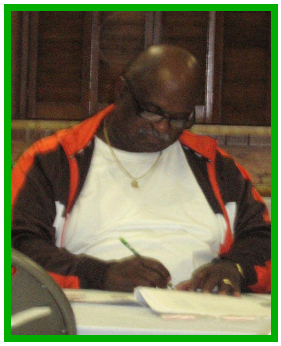
Nelda, Arlen & Harry Greer

Orila & Byron Brandt

Charles Shelby & Kurt Harding

Judy Grant

Jeff White



Rich Barnes

Jack Virta & Henry Kiester

Editor's Album by John L. Leszak

Round the Clock Philatelic Enthusiasts (part 2)

(This is the second part of an editoral taken from ***Mekeel's and Stamps Magazine, Feb. 13,* 2009.** Thanks, ***Stamp News,*** for your kind permission. What a great magazine! ***Stamp News*** can be contacted at: <http://www.stampnewsnow.com>, phone **800-635-3351**, or mail to **Stamp News, 42 Sentry Way, Merrimack, NH, 03054**.)

Some philatelists take out their stamp collections once a year to insert new supplements into their albums. Others dabble with their stamps and covers for a half hour before dinner or before bedtime. Many will occasionally carve out a weekend to devote entirely to their philatelic endeavors.

However, there's also that rare and dynamic breed of philatelists. They're the folks who have incorporated philately into their daily living routine. They practice their philately with a 24/7 level of enthusiasm and their very lives are interwoven within a philatelic infrastructure. Some people are on the brink of becoming Round the Clock Philatelic Enthusiasts and don't even realize it. Others are so immersed in their 24/7 philatelic endeavors that the rest of the world is simply background noise.

Those who embrace philately on a 24/7 basis truly reap the joy that's derived from philatelic inthusiasm. Non-philatelists might deem such enthusiasm to be eccentric, but in reality, they simply do not realize how much fun philatelists are having.

In order to properly diagnose if you're a Round the Clock Phila-telic Enthusiast, the following list of signs and symptoms has been assembled.

★After you've mounted several pages of stamps, you fondly admire how nice the stamps look.

★All your children submit school projects that include stamps.

★You have an email address that contains the words "stamp" or "cover."

★You can recite the zip code for the APS without prompting.

★You give up your current career to become a cachet maker.

★You can sit at bourse table for nine hours and have total control of your bladder.

★Your letter carrier refers to you as the "stamp guy."

★When you mail a letter, it's franked with more than two stamps.

★You keep old three-ring binders on hand, in case you need to suddenly expand your stamp collection.

★People ask to use your phone book and are alarmed when they flip through it and discover that you've used it to press stamps that you've recently soaked.

★You buy a particular pair of shoes because they come in a box that will be nice for storing covers.

★You keep a stack of back issues of *Mekeel's & Stamps* to re-read at a later date.

★You keep cartons of philatelic material in your living room for more than 36 hours after they've been delivered.

★There are more than three consecutive entries in your check ledger for philatelic purchases.

★You know your APS number by heart, but have to look up your social security number.

★You take a brown bag lunch to a stamp show so that you have more money to buy stamps.

★Relatives no longer visit for the holidays because they dread that you will make them look at your latest stamp exhibit.

★You sell your golf clubs and use the money to buy stamps.

★You watch old movies and object to the improper franking in the close up scenes of envelopes.

★ ★

If ten or more of the above scenarios relate to you, you are definitely a Round the Clock Enthusiast. If five to nine of the scenarios pertain to your philatelic endeavors, then you are on your way to becoming a Round the Clock Enthusiast. If one to four scenarios pertain to your present philatelic condition, you're working too hard; take a weekend off and play with your stamps. If none of these scenarios pertain to you, then you're in the wrong hobby, and you should take up face painting, darts or making snowmen.

As always, your comments and observations are invited!

(Thanks, John, for the use of your delightful column! - Lea)

Pat Richmond & Nelda Greer

"Christmas Tree Skirt"

On October 30, 2009, Nelda Greer of our stamp club was presented with the Christmas Tree Skirt made by the Mac Arthur Park Lutheran Church Quilters. The winning ticket was held by Nelda. Hooray!!!

Nelda says that they have a cathedral ceiling in their home and have to climb a ladder to put the star on. Her husband says that they have never had an appropriate tree skirt for their tree.

The monies from the raffle of this Christmas Tree Skirt go to the George and Gloria Schwanenburg Scholarship Fund to help young people pursue an education in the seminary. I, personally, was pleased to see someone from our stamp club get the winning ticket. All-in-all, $647.00 was raised with this project—$50.00 of thatfrom stamp club members; the skirt was hanging in the Fireside Room only two weeks. Keep up the good work, folks, it's our opportunity to thank the church for having such a wonderful meeting place for our club.

Okay, now, Nelda—we expect to be invited for a caroling party or SOMETHING so that we can witness the proper usage of the tree skirt. You can at least show us a picture of your tree and your skirt.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond